

Your definition of open source: Muft and mukt is a state of mind, not software
Favourite book: 'The Cathedral and the Bazaar' by Eric S. Raymond
Past-time: Tasting the timelessness through meditation
Favourite movie: 'Snowden' by Oliver Stone
Dream destination: Bhutan, birthplace of 'Schumacher Economics' that gives a more holistic vision to the open source philosophy
Idol: Osho, a visionary who talked about true freedom and how to exercise your individual freedom in your society

interface design and UX. This is the ultimate love affair between intuition and engineering. The huge impact of the computer industry on billions of people directly can be attributed to this synergy.

I've brought tens of thousands of people into the free and open source movement in India. How? By writing extensively about it in mainstream newspapers as well as in tech magazines, and by conducting countless seminars and public talks for the industry, government, academia, and the community. Besides, I was a core member of the *Freed.in* event, and helped to set up several chapters of Linux user groups across India. I ventured into consultancy, and guided companies on free and open source software. During my journey, I also contributed extensively to bug reports of a few GPL software in the graphics design space.

Establishing ILUG-D

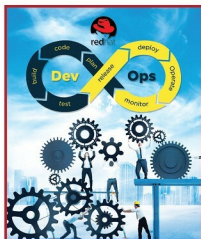
I still remember one cool evening back in 1995, when a couple of us hackers were huddled around an assembled PC. Somebody was strumming a badly-tuned guitar, an excited pet dog was barking at new guests... This was the founding of the Indian Linux Users Group, Delhi (ILUG-D). This was also the first official meet at the home of the late Raj Mathur, founding member of the ILUG-D. That meeting shaped free and open source software as a movement, and not just a licence. Everyone knows what happened over the next decade-and-a-half.

The reality of open source adoption in India

Today, it is all about free and open

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It is impressive to see the adoption of Android, which is really Linux in your pocket, but at other levels, the real potential of open source is yet to be realised by Indians.
”

source software, and of open knowledge, which for me is way beyond Linux. Honestly, I am not happy with the way open source adoption has happened in India. In this vast country, there is one and only one challenge—the mindset of people towards open source. What's happening in India is 'digital colonialism' as our minds are still ruled by proprietary software, proprietary services and a lack of understanding of privacy. We lack the understanding of our 'digital sovereignty'. To address this mindset, I wrote two whitepapers and published them on my website, www.niyam.com, which became very popular. The first was 'Seven Steps to Software Samadhi: How to migrate from Windows to GNU/Linux for the Non-techie in a Hurry'. Published under the FDL licence, this initiative acquired a life of its own among the community. The second one was 'Guerilla Warfare for Gyaan', which was about bringing in free knowledge, especially in academia. Both were received well



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